ZIV GREEN EPSTEIN

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Google Scholar Profile (as of 7/6/2026)
5663 Citations
h-index 24
i10-index 32

Research Interests:
Computational Creativity, Human-centered AI, Social Computing, Computational Social Science

POSITIONS	2025-	Postdoctoral Associate, Schwartzman College of Computing, MIT
	2024-2025	Visiting Research Associate in the Computer Science Department at the John A. Paulson School of Engineering and Applied Sciences, Harvard University
	2023-2025	Postdoctoral Fellow, Center for Human-Centered AI (HAI) and Computer Science Department, Stanford University

EDUCATION	2019-2023	Ph.D., MIT Media Lab
	2017-2019	M.A., MIT, Masters in Media Arts and Sciences
	2013-2017	Pomona College, *cum laude*, Computer Science and Mathematics double major, Media Studies minor.

ALL PUBLICATIONS

Peer-reviewed publications (=contributed equally)*

1. Epstein, ZG, Jahanbakhsh, F, Piccardi T, Gallegos, I, Sapkota, S, Zhao, D, Ugander, J, & Bernstein, M. Measuring Value Expressions in Social Media Posts. Proceedings of the International AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media (*ICWSM*) (2026)
2. Zhao, D, Jahanbakhsh, F, Roberston, Z, Piccardi, T, Epstein, ZG, Koyejo, S, & Bernstein, M. Encoding Basic Human Values in Social Media Feed Ranking Algorithm. Accepted at *CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)* (2026). Available at https://arxiv.org/abs/2509.14434

3. Prock, M*, <u>Epstein, ZG*</u>, Schroeder, H, Lee, H, Smith, A, Goblot, V, & Jahanbakhsh, F. Interpretive Cultures: Resonance, randomness and negotiated meaning for AI-assisted tarot divination. Accepted at *CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)* (2026). Available upon request.
4. Smith A, Schroeder H, <u>Epstein ZG</u>. AI Séance: recounts from designing AI for transcendence, interpretive lenses, and chance. *European Journal of Cultural Studies* (2025):10.1177/13675494251351223.
5. Wittenberg C, <u>Epstein ZG</u>, Péloquin-Skulski G, Berinsky A, Rand DG. Labeling AI-generated media online. *PNAS Nexus* (2025):10.1093/pnasnexus/pgaf170.
6. Danry, V, Pataranutaporn, P., Groh, M., <u>Epstein., ZG</u>, Maes, P. Deceptive Explanations by Large Language Models Lead People to Change their Beliefs About Misinformation More Often than Honest Explanations *In Proceedings of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)* (2025):10.1145/3706598.3713408. Honorable Mention (awarded to papers in the top 5% of submissions)
7. Ugander J* & <u>Epstein ZG</u>*. The Art of Randomness: Sampling and chance in the age of algorithmic reproduction *Harvard Data Science Review* (2024):10.1162/99608f92.f5dcab1a
8. <u>Epstein ZG</u>, Hertzmann A, et al. Art and the science of generative AI. *Science* (2023): 10.1126/science.adh4451
9. <u>Epstein ZG</u>, Sirlin N, Arechar, A, Pennycook G, Rand DG. The social media context interferes with truth discernment. *Science Advances (*2023):10.1126/sciadv.abo6169
10. Arechar A.A,..., Epstein ZG... et al. Understanding and Reducing Online Misinformation Across 16 Countries on Six Continents. *Nature Human Behavior* (2023):10.1038/s41562-023-01641-6. Winner of the 2026 BSPA Publication Award
11. <u>Epstein ZG</u>*, Foppiani N*, Hilgard S*, Sharma S*, Glassman E & Rand, D. Do explanations increase the effectiveness of AI-crowd generated fake news warnings? Proceedings of the International AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media (2022):10.1609/icwsm.v16i1.19283
12. Groh M, <u>Epstein ZG,</u> Firestone C, Picard R. Deepfake Detection by Human Crowds, Machines, and Machine-informed Crowds. *PNAS* (2022): 10.1073/pnas.2110013119
13. Lin H*, <u>Epstein ZG</u>*, Pennycook G, Rand DG. Quantifying attention via dwell and engagement in a social media browsing environment. *NeurIPS workshop All Things Attention: Bridging Different Perspectives on Attention.* 10.48550/arXiv.2209.10464
14. <u>Epstein ZG</u>. Schroeder H, Newman D. When happy accidents foster creativity: Bringing collaborative speculation to life with generative AI. *International Conference for Computational Creativity* (2022): 10.48550/arXiv.2206.00533
15. Gordon S, Mahari R, Mishra M, <u>Epstein ZG.</u> Co-creation and ownership for AI radio. *International Conference for Computational Creativity* (2022): 10.48550/arXiv.2206.00485
16. Smith, A., Schroeder, H., <u>Epstein, ZG</u>, Cook, M., Colton, S., & Lippman, A. Trash to Treasure: Using text-to-image models to inform the design of physical artefacts. *AAAI Creativity Across Modalities workshop* (2023):10.48550/arXiv.2302.00561
17. Pennycook, G*, <u>Epstein ZG,</u>* Mosleh M*, Arechar, A, Eckles D, & Rand, D. Shifting attention to accuracy can reduce misinformation online. *Nature* (2021):10.1038/s41586-021-03344-2 Honorable Mention for 2021 Behavioral Science and Policy Association Best Paper Award
18. <u>Epstein ZG</u>, Groh M, Dubey A, Pentland A. Social influence leads to the formation of diverse local trends. *CSCW.* (2021):10.1145/3479553
19. <u>Epstein ZG</u>, Berinsky A, Cole R, Gully A, M, Pennycook G, & Rand, D. Developing an accuracy-prompt toolkit to reduce COVID-19 misinformation online. *Harvard Misinformation Review.* (2021):10.37016/MR-2020-71
20. Sirlin, N., <u>Epstein, ZG</u>., Arechar, A. A., Pennycook, G. & Rand, D. Digital literacy is associated with more discerning accuracy judgments but not sharing intentions. *Harvard Misinformation Review* (2021):10.37016/mr-2020-83
21. Groh, M, <u>Epstein ZG</u>, Obradovich, N, Cebrian, C & Rahwan, I. Human detection of machine

manipulated media. Communications of the ACM (2021):10.1145/3445972. Pages 40-47 (cover feature)

22. Epstein ZG, Pennycook, G & Rand, DG. Letting the crowd steer the algorithm: Laypeople can effectively identify misinformation sources. *In Proceedings of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)* (2020): 10.31234/osf.io/z3s5k
23. Epstein ZG, Levine, S, Rand, DG & Rahwan, I. Who gets credit for AI-generated Art? *iScience*, (2020):10.1016/j.isci.2020.101515
24. Epstein ZG, Boulais O, Gordon S, & Groh, M. Interpolating GANs to Scaffold Autotelic Creativity. *International Conference for Computational Creativity Casual Creators Workshop* (2020):10.48550/arXiv.2007.11119
25. Epstein ZG, Peysakhovich, A. & Rand, DG. The Good, the Bad, and the Unflinchingly Selfish: Cooperative decision-making can be predicted with high accuracy using only three behavioral types. *Proceedings of the Conference on Economics and Computation (EC)* (2016):10.1145/2940716.2940761
26. Devadoss, S, Epstein ZG, & Smirnov, D. Visualizing Scissors Congruence. *Symposium on Computational Geometry* (2016):10.4230/LIPIcs.SoCG.2016.66
27. Rand DG, & Epstein ZG. Risking Your Life Without a Second Thought: Intuitive Decision-Making and Extreme Altruism. *PLoS ONE* (2014):10.1371/journal.pone.0109687. Listed as one of the Top 10 Insights from the Science of a Meaningful Life in 2014 by the Greater Good Science Center at UC Berkeley.
28. Padula WV,. . . , Epstein ZG,. . . et al. Using Clinical Data to Predict High-cost Performance Coding Issues Associated with Pressure Ulcers: a multilevel cohort model. *Journal of the American Medical Informatics Association (JAMIA)* (2016): 10.1093/jamia/ocw118

SUBMITTED / WORKING PAPERS

29. Epstein, ZG, Jahanbakhsh, F, Piccardi T, Peytavin, A, Gallegos, I, Sapkota, S, Zhao, D, Ugander, J, & Bernstein, M. Value misalignment of X's feed algorithm is a reflection of value tensions in engagement. Provisionally accepted at *PNAS*.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

MIT Schwarzman College of Computing

1. The Medium is the Mess (2025-2026) - seminar-style working group under Social and Ethical Responsibility in Computing (SERC) program

Institute of Digital Sciences Austria

2. Media chapter of the Founding Lab fall term (2023) - Developed curriculum, mentored students and instructed studio for IDSA's Founding Lab program, in collaboration with Ars Electronica Future Lab

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Reviewer: CHI 2021, 2023-2026, IEEE Computer Graphics and Applications 2023, IC2S2 2020, 2026, ICWSM 2020-2021, 2026, and PNAS 2021, DIS 2026.

Editorial: Handling Editor for PNAS Nexus 2026.

Workshops: Organizer for ICWSM 2021 workshop, Co-organizer for CHI 2024 workshop.

PRESENTATIONS/TALKS

Keynote addresses, plenary talks, and colloquia

1. Computer Science Colloquium, Tufts University 3/5/26
2. Keynote at Social Technologies Seminar, University of Leiden 1/23/24
3. Plenary talks at Media Lab event Beyond the Elephant in the Room in Bangkok, Thailand (live event with over 800 audience members [YouTube]). 12/15/2022

Invited talks

1. Invited speaker for BostonCHI series, Northeastern University, 3/9/26
2. Invited speaker for Information Quality (IQ) Speaker Series, Google DeepMind 11/7/25
3. Guest Lecture in Intro to Human Computer Interaction (Computer Science), Dartmouth College 11/5/25
4. Participant in TechnoMirage x Parsons School of Design panel 11/4/25
5. Guest Lecture in Social Computing (Computer Science), University of Michigan [virtual] 9/24/25
6. HCI Seminar, CSAIL MIT 9/16/25
7. Guest Lecture in CS279: Special Topics in Human-Computer Interaction (Computer Science), Harvard University 11/18/24
8. How Is Generative AI Transforming Art and Design? Sold-out panel at MIT Center for Arts, Science and Technology [YouTube] 10/26/2023
9. Interspecies Dialogue at Harvard Divinity School 10/25/2023
10. Contemporary Perspectives on the Arts in Learning at Harvard Graduate School of Education 10/25/2023
11. Art in the Age of Algorithmic Reproduction (Ethics Monday) at Safra Center for Ethics at Harvard 10/23/2023
12. The Dynamics of Attention in Digital Ecosystems. Department of Information Systems, Zefat Academic College, Israel. 3/23/2023
13. The Societal Impact of Generative AI. The MIT Museum. 2/28/2023
14. Invited talk for Poetics of the Infraordinary in the Creative Writing department at University of Pennsylvania. 9/22/2022
15. Real or fake? Evaluating human and AI deepfake detection. Synthetic Futures Livestream Event. [virtual] 2/17/2022
16. Denver Museum of Art and Science. Institute for Science & Policy Symposium on Science in the Age of Misinformation. [virtual] 12/1/2021
17. Stanford Network Information Dynamics Seminar [virtual] 5/6/2021
18. The Digital Image - Social Dimensions, Political Perspectives and Economic Constraints (German Research Foundation priority program) 4/29/2021
19. University of Pittsburgh Computational Social Science Seminar [virtual] 4/21/2021
20. Affective Brain Lab Seminar at University College London [virtual] 4/15/2021
21. Data Science / Computational Social Science Seminar Series @ UMSI (Michigan) [virtual] 4/8/2021
22. Center for Constructive Communication (MIT) [virtual] 3/31/2021

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCES

Consulting

1. OpenAI 2022
2. Jigsaw (Google) 2020-2021

Internships

1. Meta, Core Data Science on the Facebook and Society team 2019
2. MIT, Laboratory for Social Machines 2015-2016

Other

1. Member of C2PA Research Consortium (2024-)
2. Planetarium Operator, Pomona College, Claremont, CA (2016-2017)
3. Radio DJ for KSPC 88.7, Claremont, CA (2014-2016)

FELLOWSHIPS, RESIDENCIES AND AWARDS

1. Recipient, Somerville Arts Grant $2,600 (2026)
2. Artist-in-residence at Stochastic Labs, Berkeley, CA (Summer 2024 and 2025)
3. IDSA x Ars Electronica FOUNDING LAB Fellow (Fall 2023)
4. Expedition Leader for MIT Media Lab Svalbard Expedition to Longyearbyen, Norway. Hosted by Satellite Institute (Summer 2023)
5. Best Plenary Talk Award for Quantifying attention via dwell time and engagement in a social media browsing environment – International Conference on Computational Social Science (2023)
6. Best Honorable Mention Talk Award for Yourfeed: measuring attention in an experimental social media environment – International Conference on Computational Social Science (2022)
7. Resident, Mars College (2021)
8. Best Poster Presentation Award for Towards a new social laboratory: An experimental study of search through community participation at Burning Man – International Conference on Computational Social Science (2020)
9. NSF Vizzies Winner – the National Science Foundation's top data visualization award (2018)
10. Barry M. Goldwater Scholar – highly competitive national award for future scientists (2016)

SELECTED POPULAR PRESS ARTICLE

1. Vice. Your Next Psychic Reading Might Secretly Come From a Clanker. 5/21/2026. [link]
2. PBS. More tarot readers are turning to AI for advice, another sign of our growing reliance on chatbots for emotional support. 5/17/2026. [link]
3. The Conversation. How tarot readers are using AI – and what it says about our growing reliance on chatbots for emotional support and advice. 05/13/2026 [link]
4. NPR (WHYY Studio2). Will AI kill human creativity? (radio interview) 10/16/2025. [link]
5. The Atlantic. Why Does AI Art Look Like That? 8/16/2024. [link]
6. The Crimson. Stanford Fellow, Cambridge Artist Talk Art and Generative AI at Harvard Ethics Center Panel. 10/24/2023. [link]
7. MIT News. If art is how we express our humanity, where does AI fit in? (interview). 7/15/2023. [link]
8. The Conversation. Generative AI is a minefield for copyright. 05/15/2023 [link]
9. MIT News. On social media platforms, more sharing means less caring about accuracy (interview). 3/3/2023. [link]
10. Vice. Is the Panic Over AI Art Overblown? We Speak With Artists and Experts. (interview). 2/22/2023. [link]
11. Los Angeles Times. How AI-generated art is changing the concept of art itself (interview). 9/21/2022. [link]

12. New York Times. A ‘Virtual Rapper’ Was Fired. Questions About Art and Tech Remain (quoted). 9/6/2022. [link]
13. Axios. Dust, costumes, weirdness — and science: Burning Man is back (interview). 8/26/2022. [link]
14. NPR. When machine learning meets surrealist art meets Reddit, you get DALL-E mini (interview). 7/5/2022. [link]
15. WBUR. The faker: Deepfakes, lies, and cheerleading 4/22/2022 [link]
16. Scientific American. Are You Better Than a Machine at Spotting a Deepfake? 4/15/2022 [link]
17. MIT News. A remedy for the spread of false news? 3/27/2021 [link]
18. Fast Company. Google and MIT prove social media can slow the spread of fake news. 6/4/2021. [link]
19. Forbes. How We Talk About AI Affects Who Gets Credited For AI Art. 10/26/2020 [link]
20. ZDNet. People’s notions about AI are terrible, an MIT study asks whether they can be helped. 9/18/2020 [link]
21. Digg. The Creepiest Thing Online This Week Is An AI That Creates Digital Ghosts. 10/31/2018 [link]
22. Fast Company. AI is making Halloween so much spookier. 10/30/2018 [link]
23. The Economist. To understand digital advertising, study its algorithms. 4/18/2018 [link]
24. New York Times. The Trick to Acting Heroically. 8/28/2015 [link]
25. Washington Post. The secret of extreme heroes: They don’t overthink. 8/24/2015 [link]
26. Vox. The science of extreme altruism: why people risk their lives to save strangers. 10/15/2014 [link]

ARTWORKS FEATURED

1. AI Séance featured at TechnoMirage Underground Art & Design (2025)
2. Meet the Ganimals featured at Ties That Cannot Be Unbound New Art City Exhibition (2023)
3. Detect-a-fake featured at MIT Museum (2022)
4. Meet the Ganimals in CLOG x Feeds edition http://www.clog-online.com/shop/clog-feeds/ (2022)
5. Ganimals featured in the AI Exhibition at Vienna Museum of Technology (2021)
6. Errorism in collaboration with Agnieszka Kurant in her solo show at Muzeum Sztuki in Lodz, Poland (2021)
7. Life on Mars featured in the Wasteland Film Festival, Utah Music Video awards and the iPhone Film Festival /Mozimotion (2021). Online at https://vimeo.com/508951373
8. Save the Ganimals selected as SXSW Art Program finalist (2020)
9. Deep Angel Shadow Sans Substance featured at Ars Electronica (2019)
10. Field experiment conducted at Burning Man featured in Nautilus (2019). Read more at http://nautil.us/issue/74/networks/six-degrees-of-separation-at-burning-man